MUHAMMAD ZUBAIR

Red Team & Penetration Testing

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SUMMARY

Offensive Security Engineer with 3+ years of hands-on experience across web applications, APIs, Active Directory, cloud infrastructure, and enterprise networks. OSCP and CPTS certified, with experience delivering penetration testing and security assessments for international clients across black-box and grey-box environments. Strong in identifying and chaining real-world attack paths involving privilege escalation, lateral movement, Active Directory abuse, cloud misconfigurations, and endpoint security weaknesses. Experienced in translating technical findings into clear business risk and actionable remediation, with a growing focus on AI Red Teaming and emerging AI-driven attack surfaces.

CERTIFICATIONS

Offensive Security Certified Professional (OSCP) ↗ — Oct 2024
Certified Penetration Testing Specialist (CPTS) ↗ — Feb 2024
Certified Offensive AI Expert (COAE) ↗ — In Progress

WORK EXPERIENCE

Penetration Tester (Tranchulas) ↗ — London, UK (Remote)

DEC 2024 - PRESENT

- Achieved remote code execution during an authorized assessment of a hospital's public-facing assets, reported immediately, and worked with the development team to remediate the issue within 42 hours, despite a prior assessment 6 months earlier.
- Served as sole security engineer on an internally developed compliance automation platform, conducted threat modeling, application and cloud security assessments across AWS, identified and remediated 8 critical findings including privilege escalation paths and misconfigured IAM roles, and validated the platform to a production-ready security posture.
- Compromised a fully-patched Windows domain environment during a black-box engagement by chaining an AS-REP roasting attack with unconstrained delegation abuse, access went from zero-knowledge to Domain Admin in under 4 hours.
- Established internal reporting standards that framed vulnerabilities in business-risk terms with client-specific severity scoring and prioritized remediation roadmaps, adopted as the team's default delivery format.

IT Security & Infrastructure Consultant (Mutalabah) — Jeddah, KSA (Onsite)

Feb 2026 - Apr 2026

- Led end-to-end migration of 100 endpoints to a new Active Directory domain over a single weekend (Thursday evening to Sunday), maintaining zero business downtime with full operations restored for Monday.
- Migrated all user mailboxes to the new environment with zero data loss. Validated the domain against SAMA Cybersecurity Framework requirements and deployed hardened golden images with standardized tooling (Microsoft Office, Fortinet VPN, FortiEDR, 7-Zip) across all systems before go-live.

Systems & Infrastructure Technician (11ven Tech Yards) — Islamabad, PAK (Hybrid)

MAY 2023 - AUG 2024

- Administered and hardened Linux production servers hosting high-availability web services, applied the principle of least privilege, restricted the attack surface through service minimization, and maintained zero downtime through proactive monitoring and operational controls.
- Developed PowerShell and Python automation tools to diagnose complex system-level failures and built forensic-style diagnostic scripts that traced root causes across Windows internals, directly translating into the scripting instincts used in offensive security engagements.

PROJECTS

Active Directory Attack Research & Public Knowledge Series ↗

Engineered multi-domain Active Directory environments replicating architectural flaws found in real enterprise networks, Kerberoasting, ACL abuse, constrained delegation, cross-forest escalation. Documented the full attack chain in a public Medium series bridging lab setup to adversary tradecraft, reaching 500+ reads within weeks of publishing.

AI-Driven Vishing Simulation Platform

Co-engineered an adversarial AI vishing platform that cloned executive voice profiles using ElevenLabs, routed live calls via Twilio, and used LLMs to generate real-time responses, simulating a CISO impersonation attack against employees to test detection of AI-driven social engineering.

SKILLS

Offensive Security: Web Application & API Security Testing, Internal & External Network Penetration Testing, Active Directory Penetration Testing, Red Team Operations, Black-Box & Grey-Box Assessments, Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing (VAPT), Mobile Application Security Testing (iOS & Android), Source Code Review, Privilege Escalation & Lateral Movement.

Tooling: Burp Suite Pro, Metasploit Framework, Nmap, Nessus, BloodHound, Impacket Suite, Cobalt Strike, Sliver C2, Responder, CrackMapExec, Havoc, SQLmap, FFUF, Gobuster, Nikto, Wireshark, Kali Linux, Custom Python & PowerShell tooling.

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS Security Assessment & Hardening, IAM Misconfiguration Analysis, S3 Bucket Enumeration.

GRC & Security Compliance: ISO/IEC 27001, Security Frameworks & Controls, NCA ECC / CSCC, SAMA Cybersecurity Framework